सत्यमेव जयते

No. XII-019/02/2025-Map
भारत सरकार/Government of India
गृह मंत्रालय/Ministry of Home Affairs
भारत के महारजिस्ट्रार एवं जनगणना आयुक्त का कार्यालय
Office of the Registrar General & Census Commissioner of India
मानचित्र अनुभाग, पश्चिमी खण्ड -१, रामा कृष्णा पुरम, नई दिल्ली – ११००६६
Map Division, West Block-I, R.K. Puram, New Delhi-110066

Date: 09/02/2026

Census of India 2027 – Circular No. 11

Subject: Finalisation of Geospatial Database on Administrative Boundaries, Generation and Preparation of Working Maps for Census 2027

Updation of Geospatial Database on Administrative Boundaries: As a part of Census 2027 preparations, the harmonised geospatial database of administrative boundaries at all levels, viz. State/UT, District, Sub-district, Town, Ward and Village, are being updated by the respective Directorates of Census Operations (DCOs). This database shall constitute all jurisdictional changes effected during the period from 01.01.2010 to 31.12.2025, based on notifications issued by the respective Central/State/UT Governments. This work is being carried out in accordance with the methodology and guidelines prescribed in Census of India 2027 Circular Nos. 1, 2, 3 and 4, and also the instructions issued from time to time by ORGI. The accuracy and completeness of this geospatial database shall constitute the reliable foundational administrative framework for Census 2027 field operations and will be used in generation of all Map products for the depiction and dissemination of Census 2027 results.

2. **Verification of updated Maps**: Using the updated geospatial database, Sub-district Maps (showing Villages, Towns, Census Towns (CTs), Out Growths (OGs)) and Town Maps (showing Wards) have been generated (as per Circular No. 4) by concerned DCOs/Map Division, ORGI. These maps had already been forwarded to the concerned Local Revenue Authorities (for Sub-district Maps) and Urban Local Body (ULB) Authorities (for Town Maps) for verification, thereby, to ensure the following:

a) Verify that all jurisdictional changes, including those notified up to 31st December 2025, have been duly incorporated in the updated Sub-district Maps (showing Villages, Towns, CTs, OGs) and Town Maps (showing Wards). Please refer to Letter No. XII-010/21/2023-Map/12 dated 16th July, 2025 and Circular No. 4 issued on 8th September, 2025 for guidance and compliance.
b) Give special attention to the verification of Ward boundaries in all ULBs, keeping in view that Ward delimitation may have taken place after the last cycle of Ward

boundary collection. Ward boundaries of all ULBs shall be thoroughly verified and updated, wherever required, to reflect the current jurisdictional status.

c) Sub-district or Town Maps, where no jurisdictional changes have occurred after last Census 2011 and those that have already been verified and finalised, need not undergo for re-verification.
d) In some of the States/UTs where proper and accurate Village/Town boundaries are not available, for example - North Eastern States, Jammu & Kashmir, Ladakh, Chhattisgarh, etc., the Village locations (Points) have been updated using various geospatial data sources such as Pradhan Mantri Gram Sadak Yojan (PMGSY) and BharatMaps (NIC) that are available in the public domain. The DCOs of such States/UTs may use maps generated using this geospatial database for verifying and ensuring Village locations and coverage of settlement areas.
e) The DCOs shall ensure that all changes suggested by the concerned Local Authorities during the process of verification and confirmation are incorporated in the geospatial database of administrative unit boundaries on immediate basis.

3. **Integration of Short Codes:** As per Circular No. 8 issued on 9th January, 2026 by this office, it is mandatory to maintain one to one matching of administrative units in geospatial database with the administrative unit Short Codes finalised by concerned DCOs, and append the same in geospatial database. The integration of finalised Short Codes is mandatory for enabling seamless linkage amongst **Geospatial database**, the **Census Management and Monitoring System (CMMS)** portal and the **Houselisting Block Creator (HLBC)** Web Mapping Application, and shall be completed before the database is put to operational use. In order to achieve successful integration, the following guidelines must be followed:

a) Updating the Geospatial database on administrative boundaries in respect of newly created Villages/Towns with MDDS Codes available in the finalised Short Code List.
b) Linking of finalised Short Codes with Geospatial database on Administrative boundaries using MDDS_VT_2027 field and updating the relevant Short Code fields.
c) Updating both Names and Civic Status fields as per the finalised Short Codes.
d) Checking for unmatched records, if any, and update relevant Villages/Towns to ensure complete harmonisation with Short Code List.

4. **Upload of final Geospatial Database on Map Portal:** The finalised geospatial database of administrative boundaries, duly updated with finalised Short Codes, shall be uploaded by the DCOs using Map services available on the **Map Portal** (Map Division shall extend assistance for completing this task). For States/UTs that are already using Map services for Geospatial database updation-related activities, the updating of Short Codes shall be carried out directly on the same Map services. The States/UTs for which Mapping work handled at Map Division, the task will be done at Map Division in coordination with DCOs concerned. Due care must be taken while finalising this database as the same shall be treated as the administrative framework for Census 2027 and to be used during the

Houselisting Operations (HLO) phase through the **HLBC** Web Mapping Application for geo-tagging and demarcation of HLBs.

5. **Generation of Working Maps:** In order to facilitate systematic planning of HLB formation and accurate demarcation of HLBs using HLBC Web Mapping Application, for the first time in Census operations, Working Maps shall be generated using the finalised geospatial database of administrative boundaries with Short Codes at Sub-district (Rural Charge), Town (Urban Charge), Village/CT/OG and Ward levels. The Village/CT/OG, Town and Ward level Working Maps shall be generated with latest available **satellite imagery** background to enable clear identification of habitations and settlements on the ground. The enclosed templates are to be used for faster generation of these Working Maps through semi-automated process by deploying multiple workstations, which are available in Map Sections and Data Centres of DCOs. Detailed handholding to use these templates shall be given by the Map Division in due course of time. These Working Maps shall also be made available through CMMS in *Map Repository* for reference at Charge level.

Sl. No.	Working Map	Size (Depending on Area/no. of Units)	No. of Hard Copies	Features to be shown in the maps
1	Sub-districts	A2/A1/A0	2	Villages/Towns, National & State Highways, Major District Roads, Railway lines, River & Streams/Water Bodies, RF/PF (as per the availability of updated database)
2	Towns	A2/A1/A0	3	Overlaid on Wards with satellite imagery
3	Wards	A2/A1/A0	2	Overlaid on satellite imagery
4	Villages/ OGs/CTs	A2/A3	3	Overlaid on satellite imagery

6. **Printing of Working Maps:** Working Maps shall be printed as indicated above by ORGI and dispatched to the respective Charges. Two copies of each Working Map shall be used for Houselisting block (HLB) demarcation activities through the HLBC Web Mapping Application (*detailed instructions are given in CMMS/HLBC User Manual*). The third copy (***only Working Maps of Town and Village***) shall be utilized for depiction of the location of amenities during the collection of Village and Town Directory data for the preparation of the District Census Handbook (DCHB). This latter provision has been made to replace the manual sketches prepared during DCHB data collection by the respective field-level officials. A suitable tracking mechanism shall be integrated into the CMMS - Printing & Logistics module to monitor printing and dispatch.

7. **Offline HLB Demarcation using Working Maps**: Due to unavoidable situation wherein use of CMMS/HLBC Web Mapping Application not possible by a Charge, printed Working Maps at the Village/OG/CT and Ward levels shall serve as the alternative reference framework for carving and demarcating HLBs, as per the list recorded in the *"Create/View HLB"* sub-module of CMMS or in Charge Register. The Working Maps

(Village/OG/CT and Ward) with HLB demarcation shall be transmitted to the concerned DCO for the creation of geospatial HLB boundaries. This mechanism ensures that HLBs in all areas, including those without internet facilities, are made available in geospatial data form. The HLB boundaries shall subsequently be utilized for generation of Enumeration Block (EB) Maps for the Population Enumeration phase.

8. **Field Verification and marking of Boundary Corrections:** During Village/OG/CT/Ward level assessment for HLB demarcation, any required modification in administrative boundaries, based on ground verification or to ensure complete coverage of habitations/settlements, shall be clearly marked on the Working Maps by the concerned Charge. The marked maps, duly signed by the Charge Officer, shall be submitted to the concerned DCO through the designated Census coordinating official for scrutiny and necessary incorporation in the geospatial administrative boundary database. All boundary-level changes recommended by Charge Officers shall be examined and incorporated by the DCOs by the end of HLO phase or at least within one month of completion of Houselisting Operations (HLO) in that State/UT. The updation of approved changes shall be carried out using the temporary Mapping manpower deployed at DCOs. However, such corrections *shall not delay HLB demarcation. The Charge Officer may proceed with HLB demarcation based on field assessment without waiting for the boundary corrections.*

9. **Certification of Charge Maps:** The existing practice of certifying Sub-district Maps (depicting Villages/CTs/OGs/Towns) and Town Maps (depicting Wards) prior to the commencement of HLO activities has been reviewed. Although these maps are verified at the Sub-district and Town levels before being uploaded for use in the HLBC Web Mapping Application, minor discrepancies may still arise. These discrepancies may become evident during the carving out of Houselisting Blocks (HLBs), owing to differences between the administrative boundary data provided by State/UT Governments and the actual ground alignment. Such instances may require minor boundary adjustments to ensure accurate HLB formation and operational clarity. In view of this, it has been decided that certification of Charge Maps (showing Villages/Wards) shall be undertaken simultaneously with HLO activities, so that any boundary refinements identified during HLB formation are duly incorporated prior to final certification. Accordingly, the following procedure shall be adopted.

a) **Uploading of verified boundary database**: Verified administrative boundary database with finalized Short Codes shall be uploaded on the Map Portal for -
   i. HLB creation in the HLBC Web Mapping Application,
   ii. Working Map generation (in pdf format) by DCOs and
   iii. Printing and dispatch of Working Maps by ORGI.
b) **Incorporation of Boundary Adjustments**: Any minor alignment changes proposed by Charge Officers during HLO shall be examined by the concerned DCOs and incorporated into the geospatial administrative boundary database, wherever found appropriate.

c) **Generation of Final Charge Maps:** Final Charge Maps depicting Villages/CTs (for Rural Charges) and Wards/OGs (for Urban Charges) shall be generated (in pdf format) through an automated backend process by the Map Division in coordination with the Map Sections of the concerned DCOs. These maps shall be made available in the CMMS Map Repository.

d) **Integration with Charge Register**: At the time of generating the final Charge Register for HLO through CMMS, the corresponding final Charge Map and Supervisory Circle Maps shall be automatically inserted at the appropriate place in the Charge Register.

e) **Certification by Charge Officer**: The Charge Officer shall

   i. download and print the Charge Register along with the Charge Map,

   ii. sign, date, and seal both the documents; and submit them together and signed and sealed Charge Map shall constitute the **Certified Charge Map** for that Charge, and

   iii. where an **Urban Local Body comprises multiple Charges**, each Charge Map shall depict only the Ward(s) falling within that Charge. Certification of individual Charge Maps shall collectively constitute certification for the entire Urban Local Body. No separate consolidated Urban Local Body Map certification shall be required.

10. Timelines: The timelines (indicative) for compliance of various activities to be completed by the concerned are given in the **Annexure I.**

Narayanm 9/2/2026

(Mritunjay Kumar Narayan)
Registrar General & Census Commissioner of India
Telephone: 011-23388132
Email: rgi.rgi@gov.in

Encl:

1. Annexure I - Timelines
2. Sample Working Maps

To
The Director,
Directorates of Census Operations,
All States/UTs.

Copy to:

1. State/UT Nodal Officer for Census
2. Addl. RG(S/SK)/DDG
3. All Divisional Heads of ORGI
4. Guard File

Annexure I

Sl. No.	Activity	To be done by	Timeline
1	Updation of harmonised geospatial database of administrative boundaries (State/UT, District, Sub-district, Town, Ward, Village) incorporating all jurisdictional changes made up to **31st December 2025**	DCO*	12th Feb 2026
2	Preparation and verification of Sub-district and Town-level Maps, in cases where the same have not been completed earlier	DCO	15th Feb 2026
3	Finalisation of geospatial database with Short Codes of administrative boundaries after incorporating verified changes and upload on Map portal	DCO*	At least two months prior to start of HLO **or earlier**
4	Generation of Working Maps at Sub-district (Rural Charge), Town (Urban Charge), Village and Ward levels	DCO*	15 days before the use of **HLBC or 55 days prior to start of HLO or earlier**
5	Printing and dispatch of Working Maps (generated as above)	ORGI	10 days before the use of **HLBC or 45 days prior to start of HLO or earlier**
6	Use of Working Maps by Charge Officers for verification, HLB Demarcation and marking of boundary-level modifications, if any	Charge Officer	During HLB demarcation in **HLBC** prior to start of HLO
7	Incorporation of Administrative boundary-level changes, if any, suggested by Charge Officers in geospatial database	DCO*	During HLO or at least within one month after completion of HLO of that State/UT
8	Generation of final Charge Maps showing Villages/Wards and demarcated HLBs and insertion into Charge Registers	DCO / ORGI	Within one month immediately after completion of HLO of that State/UT

**Excludes States/UTs for which Mapping activities executed by Map Division of ORGI.*